Tech Dessert #2: Your License, and What You May Transmit

Take-home reference -- license classes, call signs, renewal and the grace period, and the rules on what you may and may not send over the air.

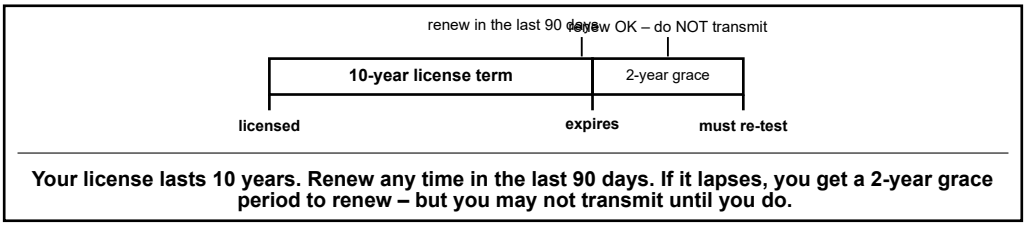
Groups T1C + T1D · 23 pool questions · Self-study handout · Practice exams at eham.net/exams

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This Dessert is a reference sheet – facts to learn, not problems to solve. Read the tables, study the license timeline, then drill the question bank until the answers come automatically.

Your License: Classes, Call Signs, and Keeping It Current

Topic	What to know	Q
License classes the FCC still issues	**Technician, General, and Amateur Extra**. Novice and Advanced are no longer issued.	T1C01
Who may request a chosen (“vanity”) call sign	**Any licensed amateur.**	T1C02
Normal license term	**10 years.**	T1C08
When you may apply to renew	Any time in the **last 90 days** before it expires.	T1C07
Grace period if it expires	**2 years** to renew – but you may **not transmit** until it is renewed.	T1C09, T1C11
When you may first transmit after passing	As soon as your license **appears in the FCC database**.	T1C10
If the FCC cannot reach you by email	Your station license can be **revoked** or your operator license **suspended**.	T1C04
A valid Technician call sign format	Two-letter prefix, a number, three-letter suffix – like **KF1XXX**.	T1C05
International communications you may make	Those **incidental to amateur radio’s purpose**, plus personal remarks.	T1C03
Operating from a boat in international waters	Allowed from a **US-documented vessel with the master’s permission**.	T1C06



Your license lasts 10 years. Renew any time in the last 90 days. If it lapses, you get a 2-year grace period to renew – but you may not transmit until you do.

What You May – and May Not – Transmit

Topic	What to know	Q
Countries you may not contact	Any whose government has told the **ITU** it objects to amateur contact.	T1D01
What “broadcasting” is, and the rule	Transmissions meant for the **general public** – one-way broadcasting is **prohibited**.	T1D02, T1D10
When coded (secret) messages are allowed	Only as **control commands to satellites or model craft**.	T1D03
When music may be transmitted	Only when **incidental to retransmitting manned spacecraft** communications.	T1D04
Selling equipment over the air	Allowed for **amateur equipment**, as long as it is **not on a regular basis**.	T1D05
Indecent or obscene language	**Always prohibited.**	T1D06
When a control operator may be paid	When the operating is **part of classroom instruction** at a school.	T1D08
Helping with news or broadcasting	Only when **directly tied to immediate safety of life or property**.	T1D09
Transmitting without identifying	Only when sending **control signals to model craft**.	T1D11
On-air test transmissions	You must **still identify** your station.	T1D12
What an auxiliary station is	A one-way link between a **remote repeater receiver and the repeater transmitter**.	T1D07

Remember: your license runs **10 years**, renew in the last **90 days**, and a lapsed license has a **2-year grace period** – but no transmitting during it. As for content, the theme is simple: amateur radio is **not broadcasting**. No transmissions aimed at the general public, no music, no secret codes, no business – and always identify, even for a quick test.

Dessert 2 Question Bank (T1C + T1D)

T1C01. For which classes of amateur radio licenses does the FCC currently issue new licenses?
A. Novice, Technician, General, Amateur Extra
B. Technician, Technician Plus, General, Amateur Extra
C. Novice, Technician Plus, General, Advanced
D. Technician, General, Amateur Extra

T1C02. Who may select a desired call sign under the vanity call sign rules?
A. Only a licensed amateur with a General or Amateur Extra Class license
B. Only a licensed amateur with an Amateur Extra Class license
C. Only a licensed amateur who has been licensed continuously for more than 10 years
D. Any licensed amateur

T1C03. What types of international communications are FCC-licensed amateur radio stations permitted to make?
A. Communications incidental to the purposes of the Amateur Radio Service and remarks of a personal character
B. Communications incidental to conducting business or remarks of a personal nature
C. Only communications incidental to contest exchanges; all other communications are prohibited
D. Any communications that would be permitted by an international broadcast station

T1C04. What may happen if the FCC is unable to reach you by email?
A. Fine and suspension of operator license
B. Revocation of the station license or suspension of the operator license
C. Revocation of access to the license record in the FCC system
D. Nothing; there is no such requirement

T1C05. Which of the following is a valid Group D call sign format for Technician class?
A. KF1XXX
B. KA1X
C. W1XX
D. All these choices are correct

T1C06. Which of the following statements is true about using your amateur radio license when operating aboard a vessel or craft in international waters?
A. Amateur operation is prohibited in international waters
B. You may only operate during maritime emergencies
C. You need special FCC authorization for maritime mobile operation
D. You may operate from a US-documented vessel with the master's permission

T1C07. How long before the expiration date may an amateur radio license renewal be requested?
A. 30 days
B. 90 days
C. 6 months
D. 1 year

T1C08. What is the normal term for an FCC-issued amateur radio license?
A. Five years
B. Eight years
C. Ten years
D. Life

T1C09. What is the grace period for renewal if an amateur license expires?
A. Two years
B. Three years
C. Five years
D. Ten years

T1C10. How soon after passing the examination for your first amateur radio license may you transmit on the amateur radio bands?
A. Immediately on receiving your Certificate of Successful Completion of Examination (CSCE)
B. As soon as your operator/station license grant appears on the ARRL website
C. As soon as your operator/station license grant appears in the FCC's license database
D. As soon as you receive your license in the mail from the FCC

T1C11. If your license has expired and is still within the allowable grace period, may you continue to transmit on the amateur radio bands?
A. Yes, for up to two years
B. Yes, as soon as you apply for renewal
C. Yes, for up to one year
D. No, you must wait until the license has been renewed

T1D01. With which countries are FCC-licensed amateur radio stations prohibited from exchanging communications?
A. Any country whose administration has notified the International Telecommunication Union (ITU) that it objects to such communications
B. Any country whose administration has notified the American Radio Relay League (ARRL) that it objects to such communications
C. Any country banned from such communications by the International Amateur Radio Union (IARU)
D. Any country banned from making such communications by the American Radio Relay League (ARRL)

T1D02. Under which of the following circumstances are one-way transmissions by an amateur station prohibited?
A. Announcements of upcoming ham radio operating events
B. Broadcasting
C. International Morse Code Practice
D. Telecommand or transmissions of telemetry

T1D03. When is it permissible to transmit messages encoded to obscure their meaning?
A. Only when using a remote station during a contest
B. Only when transmitting certain approved digital codes
C. Only when transmitting control commands to space stations or model craft
D. Never

T1D04. Under what conditions is an amateur station authorized to transmit music using a phone emission?
A. When incidental to an authorized retransmission of manned spacecraft communications
B. When the music produces no spurious emissions
C. When transmissions are limited to less than three minutes per hour
D. When the music is transmitted above 1280 MHz

T1D05. When may amateur radio operators use their stations to notify other amateurs of the availability of equipment for sale or trade?
A. Never
B. When the equipment is not the personal property of either the station licensee, or the control operator, or their close relatives
C. When no profit is made on the sale
D. When selling amateur radio equipment and not on a regular basis

T1D06. What, if any, are the restrictions concerning transmission of language that may be considered indecent or obscene?
A. The FCC maintains a list of words that are not permitted to be used on amateur frequencies
B. Any such language is prohibited
C. The International Telecommunications Union (ITU) maintains a list of words that are not permitted to be used on amateur frequencies
D. There is no such prohibition

T1D07. Which of the following is an example of an auxiliary station?
A. A station sending one-way transmissions between a remote repeater receiver and the main repeater transmitter
B. A backup radio for emergency use in case the main station radio fails
C. A station used in the Military Auxiliary Radio System for linking government and amateur stations in a digital network
D. A second station utilized in multi-operator contest stations

T1D08. In which of the following circumstances may the control operator of an amateur station receive compensation for operating that station?
A. When the communication is related to the sale of amateur equipment by the control operator's employer
B. When the communication is a part of classroom instruction at an educational institution
C. When the communication is made to obtain emergency information for a local broadcast station
D. All these choices are correct

T1D09. When may amateur stations transmit information in support of broadcasting, program production, or news gathering, assuming no other means is available?
A. When such communications are directly related to the immediate safety of human life or protection of property
B. When broadcasting communications to or from the space shuttle
C. Where non-commercial programming is gathered and supplied exclusively to the National Public Radio network
D. Never

T1D10. How does the FCC define broadcasting for the Amateur Radio Service?
A. Two-way transmissions by amateur stations
B. Any transmission made by the licensed station
C. Transmission of messages directed only to amateur operators
D. Transmissions intended for reception by the general public

T1D11. When may an amateur station transmit without identifying on the air?

A. When the transmissions are of a brief nature to make station adjustments
B. When the transmissions are unmodulated
C. When the transmitted power level is below 0.1 watt
D. When transmitting signals to control model craft

T1D12. Which of the following is required when making on-the-air test transmissions?

A. Identify the transmitting station
B. Conduct tests only between 10 p.m. and 6 a.m. local time
C. Notify the FCC of the transmissions
D. All these choices are correct

Answer Key

T1C01: D	T1C02: D	T1C03: A	T1C04: B	T1C05: A
T1C06: D	T1C07: B	T1C08: C	T1C09: A	T1C10: C
T1C11: D	T1D01: A	T1D02: B	T1D03: C	T1D04: A
T1D05: D	T1D06: B	T1D07: A	T1D08: B	T1D09: A
T1D10: D	T1D11: D	T1D12: A		